Protein Is A Cashback Card For Fat Loss

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 17, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/rbUU33_t5lM Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Protein's thermic effect burns 20–30% of its own calories during digestion — far more than fats or carbs — making it a natural "cashback" mechanism that helps create a calorie deficit for fat loss.

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🔥 The Thermic Effect of Protein 0:00

- When you eat protein, your body burns **20–30% of the calories** from that protein just through the process of digesting it
  - This is called the thermic effect of food (TEF)
  - Fats and carbohydrates have a far lower thermic effect — "it's not even close"
- The core fat-loss equation: you must burn more calories than you consume
  - Of all macronutrients, protein forces your body to expend the most calories simply to process it
  - Therefore, prioritizing protein gives you a structural advantage in achieving a calorie deficit

💳 The Cashback Card Analogy 0:22

- Carter frames protein as a "cashback card" and a "cheat code" for fat loss
  - For every **100 calories of protein you eat, you only net 70–80 calories absorbed** — the rest is burned in digestion
- Analogy: using an Apple Card at the Apple Store gives you the highest cashback percentage when buying Apple products
  - "Same with protein — you get the highest amount of calories back"
  - The implication: just as you'd use the right card to maximize rewards, you should use protein to maximize your calorie-burning return

> "Protein is like a cashback card. It's like a cheat code. Every 100 calories of protein you digest, you're only going to absorb between 70 and 80 of those calories."

- Takeaway: deliberately prioritizing protein in your diet is one of the simplest, most effective levers for fat loss because the thermic discount is automatic and built into every meal